

Pen is mightier

Livescribe has recently launched a next generation digital pen echo that can record sound in sync with the words

Unmanned weapon

Britain's Ministry of Defense recently unveiled an unmanned stealth attack aircraft, that chooses its own targets without human intervention

Bazaar

ASUS VG236H

A new dimension in monitors

ASUS presents the next generation of 3D LCD monitors with their new VG236H model, which is a 23-inch HD1080 LCD monitor. In terms of style, it's neat looking with its glossy black finish.

Along with the standard DVI, it also has an HDMI input as well as component connectors. Speakers aren't part of the package.

One of the key features is the height adjustment and front swivel. The OSD controls are present on the right bottom of the display and the interface of the OSD is simple to use.

Perhaps the biggest feature and the reason for its ₹41,000 price tag is the NVIDIA 3D Vision support for 3D display. The monitor goes up to 120Hz for that very reason. However, it was very difficult to get that working. The 3D effect works well in dark but is not very impressive.



But as this is the first generation of 3D monitors, effects are not smooth and visually appealing.

This monitor gave a rather impressive 734:1 contrast ratio when we tested it with out Spyder3 Elite. However with Displaymate colour tests, a different story came in light. We noticed that there was some banding across all colors especially in black, which had a little bit of red and greens being rendered with the some shades of Grey. We noticed no lag in games.

This is a monitor destined for gamers. But at ₹41,000, you can opt for a good quality panel such as the 27-inch Dell U2711 with a resolution of 2560 x 1440, that is much more than that provided by this monitor.

Specifications

screen : 23-inch (58.4cm);
resolution : 1920 x 1080;
video input: Dual-link DVI-D (support NVIDIA 3D Vision) / Component(YPbPr) / HDMI ; response time : 2 ms

Contact

Vinay Shetty
Phone: +91-22-6766 8800
E-mail: reachus@asus.com
Web site: www.asus.in
Price: ₹41,000 (excluding taxes)

6.5
10

Features:.....7.5
Performance:.....7
Build Quality:.....6
Value for Money:.....5

Specifications

Processor: Intel Core 2 U7300;
RAM: 4 GB; Graphics card:
NVIDIA GeForce GT335M;
HDD capacity: 500GB;
11-inch 1366x768 display

Contact

Dell India Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: +91-80-2506 8026
E-mail: Suhas.j@dell.com
Web site: www.dell.co.in
Price: ₹70,000

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Features:.....7
Performance:.....7
Build quality:.....7
Value for money:.....4.5

Alienware M11x

Not ridiculously good

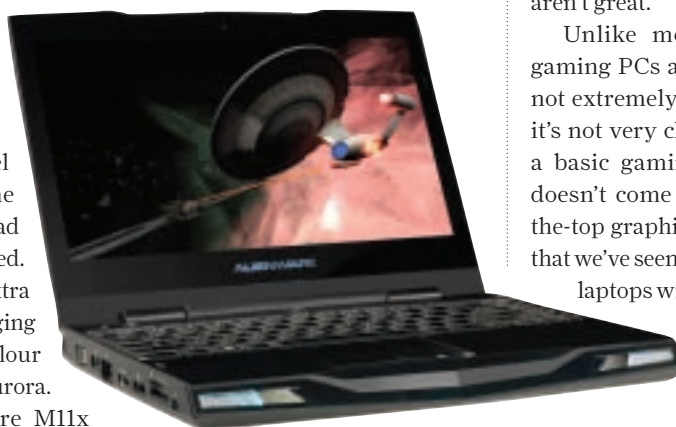
The new Alienware M11x is here to thrill you. Weighing in at around 2 kg, it's not very heavy and it's 11.6-inch widescreen format ensures that you don't have a bulky laptop either. The downside is the lack of an optical drive.

The front panel is good, but the keys on the keypad are kind of cramped. It also has some extra features like changing keypad display colour like that in Dell Aurora.

The Alienware M11x

comes with Intel Core 2 U7300 processor and a NVIDIA GeForce GT 335M graphics card.

Performance is decent when it comes to application



benchmarks. PC Mark Vantage churns out 2,826 points whereas the video encoding test took 162 seconds to encode a 100 MB file. Doom 3 scores aren't very impressive either. In short, the performance is decent but nothing that will match a decent gaming desktop.

The display renders decent colours but the viewing angles aren't great.

Unlike most Alienware gaming PCs and laptops, it's not extremely expensive, but it's not very cheap either. It's a basic gaming laptop that doesn't come with the over-the-top graphics performance that we've seen in the past from

laptops with two graphics cards, especially from brands such as Alienware.